

Product Requirements Document

CheatMealFinder

Local Street Food & Food Truck Discovery Platform

What the product is, who it serves, and how users will experience it

Document Version	1.0	Status	DRAFT
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Author	Project Team (Student Developers)	BRD Reference	v1.0 (2026-09-24)
TRD Reference	v1.0 (2026-09-24)	Next Review	Week 4

Purpose of This Document

The BRD defined **why** CheatMealFinder exists and the TRD defined **how** it will be built. This PRD defines **what the product looks and feels like** from the user's side: who the users are, the stories that describe their needs, the step-by-step flows they will follow, and the product-level measures of success.

1. Product Vision

A trusted, craving-first street food discovery platform for [City/College Area] that connects hungry people with the dishes they actually want — the spiciest wings, the best late-night waffles — while giving local food trucks and street vendors their first real digital presence, through a simple mobile-first web experience.

One-Sentence Pitch

“Type what you’re craving — get the exact dish, the exact truck, and honest reviews from people who have eaten it.”

The product succeeds when a user with a specific craving can go from “I want something” to “I know exactly where to go” in under a minute — and when vendors start hearing “I found you on CheatMealFinder.”

2. Target Personas

Personas keep the team honest: every design decision is checked against a real person’s goal, frustration, and habits — not against our assumptions.

Persona	Goals	Frustrations	Key Behaviors
The Craving Hunter (student, 20)	Satisfy a specific craving right now — spicy, sweet, cheap, or late-night	Asking around on chat groups gets contradictory answers; Google shows restaurants, not street stalls	Searches by mood/keyword (“spiciest wings”); decides fast; reads only top 2–3 reviews
The Foodie Reviewer (local foodie, 26)	Share discoveries and build a reputation for good taste	Nowhere to leave structured reviews of street food; photos get lost in Instagram stories	Writes detailed reviews with photos; checks back for replies; loyal to favourite trucks
The Food Truck Owner (vendor, 34)	Get discovered by new customers without paying for ads	Invisible online; location and hours change constantly; no budget for marketing	Relies on word of mouth; updates menu seasonally; checks phone between rush hours
The Platform Admin (team moderator)	Keep listings accurate and reviews trustworthy	Duplicate vendor entries; fake 5-star reviews; spam comments	Reviews flagged content daily; verifies new vendors against maps; exports weekly reports

3. User Stories (Prioritized)

*Stories follow the standard format — As a [persona], I want [capability], so that [benefit]. Priorities: **Must Have** = launch blocker · **Should Have** = strongly desired · **Nice to Have** = if time allows.*

ID	As a...	I want to...	So that...	Priority	BRD Link
US-01	Craving Hunter	Search dishes by keyword like “spiciest wings”	I find exactly what I crave in one search, not ten group chats	Must Have	FR-05, FR-08
US-02	Craving Hunter	Filter by category, price range, and spice level together	I only see options that match my budget and heat tolerance	Must Have	FR-05
US-03	Craving Hunter	See a vendor page with dishes, average rating, hours, and location	I can decide and go without needing any other app	Must Have	FR-10

ID	As a...	I want to...	So that...	Priority	BRD Link
US-04	Foodie Reviewer	Rate a dish 1–5 stars with a written comment	My experience helps others choose well	Must Have	FR-06
US-05	Craving Hunter	See a “Top Rated Food Trucks” leaderboard	I trust the crowd’s verdict when I have no preference	Must Have	FR-07
US-06	Foodie Reviewer	Register with my email and have only one review per dish	The ratings stay fair and can’t be gamed	Must Have	FR-01, FR-06
US-07	Platform Admin	Approve new vendors and flag/remove fake reviews	The platform keeps its reputation for honesty	Should Have	FR-02, FR-09
US-08	Food Truck Owner	Be listed with signature dishes, hours, and type (truck/stall)	New customers can actually find me	Must Have	FR-02, FR-03
US-09	Foodie Reviewer	Get an email confirming my review was posted	I know my contribution counted	Nice to Have	—
US-10	Craving Hunter	Sort search results by price (low→high) or rating	I can trade off cheap vs. best instantly	Nice to Have	FR-05

4. Functional Specifications — Key Flows

These step-by-step flows describe exactly what the user sees and what the system does at each step. They are the blueprint the developers implement and the testers verify against.

4.1 The Craving Search Flow (US-01, US-02)

- User types a craving into the search box — e.g., “wings” — or browses a category tile (Street Food / Dessert / Indo-Chinese)
- User optionally sets filters: price range slider, minimum spice level (1–5 flame icons), vendor type (truck or stall)
- System runs one indexed query joining dishes, vendors, and categories; results appear in under 2 seconds
- Each result card shows: dish photo, name, price, spice level, vendor name, and average rating (e.g., 4.6 ★)
- User taps a card → vendor detail page: full dish list, hours, location, and all reviews for that dish
- User taps “Spiciest first” toggle → same results re-sorted by spice_level DESC

4.2 The Review Flow (US-04, US-06)

- From a dish’s vendor page, logged-in user taps “Write a review”
- User picks 1–5 stars (required) and writes a comment (optional, max 500 characters)
- System checks the UNIQUE rule: if this user already reviewed this dish, the form shows their existing review for editing instead
- On submit, the review saves with dish_id and user_id foreign keys and appears on the page instantly
- The dish’s average rating and the vendor’s leaderboard score recalculate (GROUP BY query)
- A confirmation message appears: “Review posted — thanks for helping the community!”

4.3 The Leaderboard Flow (US-05)

- User opens the “Top Rated” page from the main navigation
- System aggregates all reviews with GROUP BY vendor, computing AVG(rating) and COUNT(reviews)
- Vendors with fewer than 3 reviews show “Not enough reviews yet” instead of a score — honesty over false precision
- The ranked list displays: rank, vendor name + type badge, average rating, number of reviews, and best-rated dish
- Tapping a vendor opens its detail page

4.4 The Vendor & Admin Flow (US-07, US-08)

- A new vendor (truck or stall) is added by the admin: name, location, opening hours, vendor type
- System enforces UNIQUE(name + location) — a duplicate triggers: “This vendor already exists — edit it instead?”
- Admin adds the vendor’s signature dishes with price, category, and spice level
- A community member flags a suspicious review; admin sees it in a moderation queue with the flag reason
- Admin removes it with a mandatory reason note; the record is soft-deleted (is_flagged) so history is preserved

5. Non-Functional Product Requirements

Area	Requirement	Why It Matters
Mobile-first design	70%+ of users browse on phones; touch targets ≥48px; single-column card layout on small screens	Cravings happen on the street, not at a desk
Speed perception	Search results skeleton-shown while loading; results in <2s (BRD O3)	Hungry users abandon slow sites in seconds
Trust signals	Review counts shown next to every rating; “Not enough reviews” shown honestly instead of a fake score	Credibility is the product’s only moat
Visual spice indicator	Flame icons (1–5) on every dish card — never text-only	Spice level is a headline feature; it must be scannable
Accessibility	Screen-reader labels on flame ratings and filters; alt text on dish photos; full keyboard navigation	WCAG compliance is a BRD requirement (NFR)
Language & tone	Friendly, food-loving tone (“Your next craving awaits”); no jargon anywhere user-facing	The product should feel like a friend who knows every food truck

6. Out of Scope (Explicitly)

Reaffirming the BRD boundaries from a product perspective — these features are tempting but excluded from this version.

■ EXCLUDED FROM THIS VERSION (v2.0 candidates)

- Online ordering, payments, or pre-ordering
- Live GPS tracking of food trucks

- Delivery integration
- Vendor self-service dashboards
- Native iOS/Android apps (web-only MVP)
- AI-powered recommendations

7. Success Metrics (Product-Level)

These product metrics sit on top of the BRD’s business KPIs and tell us whether the experience itself is working.

Metric	Baseline	Target (Week 8)	How We Measure It
Search success rate	N/A	70% of searches end in a vendor page visit	Click-through on search results
Reviews per dish (top 50 dishes)	N/A	≥3 reviews	Review count query per dish
Avg. session length	N/A	>3 minutes	Server access-log analysis
Leaderboard usage	N/A	30% of weekly visitors view Top Rated	Route hit counter
Repeat reviewers	N/A	25% of reviewers post a 2nd review within 2 weeks	Users table vs user_reviews timestamps
Admin moderation response	N/A	Flagged reviews handled within 24h	Moderation audit log timestamps

8. Approvals

This document is approved as the product baseline for CheatMealFinder. Changes to prioritized user stories require re-approval.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Product Owner / Team Lead			
Tech Lead			
Faculty Advisor			

Document history: v1.0 (24 Sep 2026) — Initial draft, aligned with BRD v1.0 and TRD v1.0.